

IN-SCHOOL DISCIPLINARY MEASURES

Loudoun County School Board believes that fair and equitable discipline practices will contribute to the quality of a student's educational experience. Except as authorized by this policy, all discipline measures shall be imposed by the school principal or designee. The principal or designee should employ practices that are positive and restorative in nature and a continuum of progressive discipline, interventions, supports, and consequences that are consistent with prevention and early intervention strategies.

In addition to the disciplinary measures authorized herein, the principal or designee is authorized, after consideration of positive discipline alternatives, to remove students from school, if necessary, to provide a safe learning environment for all students. Student disciplinary procedures regarding suspension and expulsion are provided for in Policy [8220 and its associated Regulations](#), and student disciplinary procedures regarding their exclusion from student interscholastic, co-curricular, and extracurricular activities are provided for in Policy [8350](#).

A. Intervention and Counseling. Any licensed employee of the School Board may provide intervention based on progressive discipline measures when a student is observed or otherwise known to have violated a school rule. Support will be provided to students who engage in inappropriate behavior and students who are impacted by inappropriate behavior. School personnel will assist students in understanding how their behavior affects others, developing healthy relationships, and making good choices to continue their learning. For serious or repeated violations of school rules, the employee should also refer the student to the principal for other disciplinary measures and to the Unified Mental Health Team for review of the student's home life, current situation in school (e.g., grades, disability, attendance, etc.), and possible referral for a functional behavior assessment and behavior intervention plan.

B. Restorative Practices. Students who commit infractions while on school property, participating in or attending any school-sponsored activity—regardless of its location, including travel to and from an event, going to or returning from school—irrespective of the mode of transportation, or that substantially disrupt school operations, regardless of where such conduct occurred, may be given an opportunity to understand how their behavior affects others in the school community, including students, teachers, and parent/caregivers, through a process that directly involves relevant stakeholders to repair the harm caused. With the support of the Unified Mental Health Team, students may participate in “circles,” “peer mediations,” or other “conferences” to allow affected parties to come together in a safe environment to explore how everyone has been affected by an offense and, when possible, to decide how to repair the harm. Principals may use restorative practices in conjunction with, or as part of, other dispositions.

C. Detention. A student may be assigned detention at the school beyond regular school hours for violation of school rules and may be required during this time to engage in activities to promote positive behavior. A student may be assigned detention only by the principal or designee. Parents or guardians must be informed at least 1 day

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or more in advance of such detention so that they may fulfill their responsibility to provide necessary transportation for the student.

D. Denial of School Privileges. A student may be denied normal non-instructional/non-curricular school privileges for a specified period of time by the principal or designee when such denial of privileges serves as appropriate corrective action for the student's misconduct. Per Policy 5011(A)(3), unstructured activity time is mandatory and should not be viewed as a privilege to be taken away. Therefore, every student is entitled to unstructured activity time and it should not be revoked as a disciplinary consequence or used as time to make up classwork. An exception to this guideline is permitted only when a student commits a disciplinary infraction during unstructured activity time and the logical consequence would be a temporary suspension for that student at the time of the infraction.

E. School-Based Community Service. A student may be assigned a non-hazardous school-based community service activity that is restorative and promotes positive student engagement at school and in the community. School-based community service activities may be scheduled before, during, or after the school day, when not in class, lunch, or recess, or on one or more specific non-school dates determined by the school administration and parent(s)/guardian(s) of the student. School-based community service assignments should be made only by the principal or designee or teacher, and the student must properly be supervised during the assigned activity by LCPS staff. Students assigned community service as a disposition will not be allowed to operate machinery, power tools, or equipment that requires training. No student shall be assigned a school-based community service activity without approval by the parent/guardian.

F. Removal from Class. After school staff have utilized early intervention strategies, based on positive behavior and restorative discipline, to address and promote appropriate behaviors in the classroom, a student may temporarily be removed by the principal or designee or teacher for improper behavior in any class or activity. If removed from the classroom, the student will be assigned to complete schoolwork or study in another place. Parent(s) or guardian(s) of any student shall be notified if a student is removed from instruction for any discipline action or for any other reason if it is not related to their Comprehensive Support Plan, Safety Plan, IEP, or BIP.

G. In-School Restriction. For serious or repeated violations of school rules, a principal or designee may assign a student to in-school restriction at the school. During the period of assignment to in-school restriction, the student may be isolated from normal school activities and may be denied non-instructional/non-curricular school privileges and participation in or attendance at student interscholastic, co-curricular, and extracurricular activities. The student may engage in restorative dialogue in order to understand the impact of their behavior, make positive behavior changes, and complete academic assignments. Parent(s) or guardian(s) of the affected student shall be notified of in-school restriction.

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H. Denial of Bus Transportation. Subject to, and notwithstanding, Policy 6210 (Student Transportation) and its accompanying Regulation and Policy 6220 (Student Safety and Discipline on Buses), students who misbehave on school buses may be denied the privilege of being transported on school buses for a short period of time, in accordance with this policy's accompanying Regulation. The principal or designee or the Director of Transportation may deny transportation privileges in compliance with the requirements of IDEA. Attempts will be made by school personnel to utilize positive and restorative measures for intervention and to promote safety on the bus. Continued or serious misbehavior may be punished by a longer period of denial of transportation privileges and other discipline measures as appropriate. Parent(s) or guardian(s) of any student denied transportation shall be notified.

I. Procedural Requirements for Notice. The procedural requirements for notice provided for herein shall not apply in any case where such disciplinary measures are implemented during a field trip (see Policy [5070](#)). School personnel shall maintain order and discipline while on a field trip, foreign trip, or other activity away from the school the student regularly attends. Once the field trip, foreign trip, or other activity has ended and the students return to school, school personnel may additionally consider applicable discipline measures under Policy [8220](#), and exclusion from extracurricular activities, as provided for in Policy [8350](#).

J. Appeal Rights and Procedures. Disciplinary actions taken in accordance with paragraphs A-G, and I of this policy are not appealable. Parents may petition for review of denials of bus transportation in the same manner as short-term suspensions, per Regulation 8220-1. Parent(s) and guardian(s) are encouraged, however, to discuss disciplinary actions with the school principal under their administrative review.

K. Tracking. School administration will track and document patterns of classroom removal when they occur on more than two occasions. The superintendent or designee will provide biannual reports to the school board regarding disproportionality trends in this data.

[Former Policy 8-26]

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Cross Refs: Policy [8220](#), [Regulation 8220-1](#), Student Disciplinary Consequences, Policy [8350](#), Exclusion from Extracurricular Activities, Policy [5070](#), Field Trips, Policy [6210](#), Student Transportation, Policy [6220](#), Student Safety and Discipline on Buses, Policy [5011](#), Unstructured Activity Time